

THE TESLA DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on Tesla's cars, autonomy, robots, energy and stock

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2026

MARKET DATA AS OF THU OCT 8 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

Full Self-Driving gets a new European name, Texas adds 150 Cybercabs overnight, and Shanghai posts its best month of 2026

Tesla's European websites now sell Full Self-Driving (FSD) (Supervised) as "Tesla Assisted Driving," a rename that follows talks with Germany's transport ministry, which has promised to back European Union (EU) approval in a vote expected no earlier than December. In Texas, Tesla added a record 150 Cybercabs to the state's automated-vehicle registry in a single batch, nearly doubling the purpose-built robotaxi's count to 319. Lemonade extended its FSD insurance discount to older Hardware 3 cars running the new v14 Lite.

China's passenger car association said Tesla sold 95,366 China-made cars in September, its highest monthly total this year, as exports from Shanghai rose 58%. Pilot and Tesla opened their first shared Megacharger site for the Tesla Semi in Georgia, and Elon Musk received the National Medal of Science at the White House. The stock eased 0.74% to \$375.00 on Thursday while the Nasdaq 100 fell 1.39%. Tesla has filed nothing new with the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) since Thursday morning; third-quarter results arrive October 21.

I • FULL SELF-DRIVING (FSD)

In Europe, "Full Self-Driving" becomes "Tesla Assisted Driving"

The rebrand answers Germany's complaint that the old name was misleading, while Reuters reporting puts the Dutch approval behind Tesla's European push under a harsher light.

A new name, a German ally

Tesla has replaced the "Full Self-Driving (Supervised)" branding on its European websites with "Tesla Assisted Driving," [Not a Tesla App reported](#) on Thursday. The change follows discussions with Germany's Federal Ministry for Transport, which had called the FSD name "somewhat misleading" because the system does not take over the complete driving task, [Benzinga reported](#). Tesla's German safety site now uses the new name, and its UK support pages use "Tesla Assisted Driving Basic." The software itself is unchanged: it still requires a supervising driver.

"Tesla has just officially renamed FSD (Supervised) to "Tesla Assisted Driving" across all of Europe. The change came after discussions with Germany's Transport Ministry. This should help with getting EU-wide approval. Tesla's European websites now displays the new name."

SAWYER MERRITT · @SAWYERMERRITT · [POST](#), THU 3:03 P.M. EDT

Germany's support matters because an EU-wide approval needs a qualified majority in the Technical Committee on Motor Vehicles (TCMV): at least 15 of 27 member states representing 65% of the bloc's population. Transport Minister Steffen Bilger said September talks with Tesla produced an agreement that the system may exceed the speed limit by at most 10% and that the driver stays fully responsible. "My goal is for Tesla drivers to be able to use the benefits of Assisted Driving throughout the EU as quickly as possible," he said, [per Benzinga](#). Sweden has said it would vote against unless Tesla

removes its speed-offset function, and France has started its own road tests, [EV reported](#).

WHERE FSD (SUPERVISED) IS APPROVED IN THE EU		
COUNTRY	DATE (2026)	ROUTE
Netherlands	Apr 10	RDW provisional approval
Lithuania	May 20	Recognized Dutch approval
Estonia	May 29	Recognized Dutch approval
Denmark	Jun 9	Recognized after testing
Belgium	Jun 10	Recognized after Flanders tests
Slovenia	Sep 7	Recognized Dutch approval
Czech Republic	Sep 21	Recognized Dutch approval
Croatia	Sep 29	Recognized Dutch approval
Slovakia	Pending	Minister: "within days"

Dates: [EV](#). Slovakia: [Investing.com](#).



A gold Tesla Cybercab on Interstate 280 near Palo Alto, California, on September 19, 2026.
PHOTO: DANIEL LU (DLLU), "TESLA CYBERCAB ON INTERSTATE 280 NEAR PALO ALTO," WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY-SA 4.0 · CROPPED

The Dutch review under scrutiny

The Netherlands' vehicle authority, the RDW, granted the approval every other EU country has recognized. A [Reuters investigation](#) based on hundreds of pages of emails found that Tesla often tried to set the terms of that review, and that independent researchers said Tesla's European safety study cannot support the claim that FSD saves lives. In April 2025 Tesla disputed a €365,000 RDW invoice as an "extremely high cost"; a week later an RDW staffer invited Tesla to suggest how the regulator might reduce its effort, and the RDW later let Tesla use its own test reports and gave it advance notice of tests, [Electrek summarized](#) on Thursday. The RDW [told Reuters](#) that engagement with manufacturers "does not

compromise the independence or thoroughness of our assessment."

Robotaxi: 150 Cybercabs in one batch

Tesla registered 150 more Cybercabs with the Texas Department of Motor Vehicles on Thursday, lifting the count from 169 to 319, [Cybercab.News reported](#); it is the largest single batch on the list so far. The Model Y count held at 420, so Tesla's registered Texas robotaxi fleet now stands at 739, the first time it has passed 700, [EV noted](#). A registration is not a car in paid service: Austin remains the only city where the public can pay for a Cybercab ride.

"Woah! Tesla just registered a record 150 Cybercabs for its Robotaxi fleet, bringing the total number of Cybercabs registered to date to 319 (up from 169), according to the Texas DMV. Tesla just nearly doubled its registered Cybercabs overnight."
SAWYER MERRITT · @SAWYERMERRITT · [POST](#), THU 8:45 P.M. EDT

Federal regulators are watching the same car. The National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) has given Tesla until October 30 to answer its special order on how the Cybercab, which has no steering wheel or pedals, was certified to federal safety standards, [EVwire reported](#); Tesla had asked for eight weeks.

Software: v14.3.11 and v14.3 Lite

Software 2026.33.5, which carries FSD (Supervised) v14.3.11 for AI4 (Hardware 4) cars and v14.3 Lite for Hardware 3 (HW3) cars, went first to Tesla's early-access group; tracking data from TeslaFi and Tessie showed v14.3.11 on less than 1% of the fleet, [Tesla Oracle reported](#) on Thursday. The release notes are the same as the previous version's and include the Automatic Collision Evasion feature for AI4 cars.

QUICK HIT

Lemonade now takes 30% off the price of miles driven on FSD (Supervised) v14 Lite in HW3 Teslas in Arizona, Colorado and Tennessee; HW4 cars on v14.2 or newer keep a 50% discount, the insurer [announced](#) at 8:19 a.m. EDT Thursday.

II · SALES & DEMAND

Shanghai's best month of 2026

Exports surged in September while deliveries inside China fell for a fourth straight month.

Tesla sold 95,366 China-made cars wholesale in September, up 5.01% from a year earlier, the China Passenger Car Association (CPCA) said on Friday. Wholesale sales count both cars delivered in China and cars exported from the Shanghai factory. September's total beat July's 93,579 and was the strongest month since December 2025, [CnEVPost reported](#).

The domestic picture is weaker. Deliveries inside China fell for a fourth straight month year on year, and over the first nine

months they are down 11.93% to 381,088, while Shanghai exports more than doubled to 361,972. Exports made up 48.71% of the plant's wholesale sales this year, up from 28.64% a year earlier. Domestic deliveries in China were 29.21% of Tesla's 486,532 global third-quarter deliveries. To support orders, Tesla is offering final-payment reductions of 5,000 yuan across the Model 3 lineup and 7,000 yuan on selected Model Y variants for orders placed by October 31.

30,529

September exports from the Shanghai factory, up 58.29% year on year (CPCA via CnEVPost)

64,837

September deliveries inside China, down 9.35% year on year but up 29.55% from August

275,111

Third-quarter wholesale sales, a quarterly record, up 13.73%

743,060

Wholesale sales in the first nine months, up 22.54%

III · ENERGY & CHARGING

Semi charging comes to the truck stop

Pilot and Tesla opened their first shared Megacharger site near Savannah, with three more close behind, and the Supercharger map kept growing.

Pilot, North America's largest travel center network, and Tesla have opened their first Tesla Megacharger site at Pilot #1390 in Ellabell, Georgia, with six heavy-duty stalls, [Pilot announced](#). Twelve more locations are under construction. Three are close to finished: a Flying J in Tulare, California, due to open Friday, October 9, a Flying J in Fort Stockton, Texas, and a Pilot in North Las Vegas, Nevada. Each site will have four to eight stalls on Tesla's V4 cabinets; according to Tesla, each stall delivers up to 1.2 megawatts (MW), enough to restore 60% of a Semi's charge in 30 minutes. The two companies announced the partnership in January for routes along I-5, I-10 and other freight corridors.

"Pilot is proud to bring heavy-duty charging directly to key trucking routes and pair it with the services and amenities drivers rely on."

SHANNON STURGIL, SENIOR VICE PRESIDENT OF ALTERNATIVE FUELS, PILOT · [PRESS RELEASE](#)



Two pre-production Tesla Semi trucks in Rocklin, California, on March 8, 2018 (license plates blurred).

PHOTO: KORBITR, "TESLA SEMI 6," WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · PUBLIC DOMAIN · CROPPED

Tesla Semi (@tesla_semi) [posted](#) at 7:10 p.m. EDT Thursday: "New Megacharger sites between Atlanta & Savannah now online. Many more Southeast sites coming soon." Tesla Charging [listed](#) the Ellabell site at 12:43 a.m. EDT Friday.

New Superchargers

Tesla Charging also posted new Supercharger sites in [Chicago](#) (16 stalls), [Woodbridge Township, New Jersey](#) (16), [Port St. Lucie, Florida](#) (12), [Kiskunfélegyháza, Hungary](#) (12) and [Bedok Mall in Singapore](#) (4).

QUICK HIT

Supercharger for Business. A six-stall site in Redmond, Washington, opened under the Resound Energy name, part of the program that lets other companies buy and brand Tesla Superchargers, Tesla Charging [posted](#) at 9:46 p.m. EDT Thursday.

IV · AI, HONORS & PRODUCTS

"Tesla AI" becomes "Tesla Super Intelligence"

Tesla's AI account adopted the administration's preferred term on the day Musk received the National Medal of Science, and a Halloween software build began rolling out.

From @Tesla_AI to @TeslaSI

Tesla's AI account on X now goes by "Tesla Super Intelligence" under the handle @TeslaSI, with more than 510,000 followers; the @Tesla_AI handle no longer exists. "Tesla AI has officially been renamed to Tesla SI (Super Intelligence)," Sawyer Merritt [posted](#) at 8:12 p.m. EDT Thursday. The Trump administration now refers to artificial intelligence as "super intelligence" after

the president issued an executive order renaming the technology, [NBC News noted](#).

A National Medal of Science for Musk

President Donald Trump presented Elon Musk with the National Medal of Science on Thursday at the Science: A New Golden Age Summit at the U.S. Institute of Peace in Washington, alongside Sergey Brin, Jensen Huang and Lisa Su;

Satya Nadella and Michael Dell received the National Medal of Technology and Innovation. Musk's citation, [per the White House](#), honors "engineering achievements of extraordinary ambition and scale that have pushed the frontiers of space exploration, intelligent systems, communications, and beyond."

"Elon created Tesla, the first successful new car manufacturer in over 75 years, producing the first commercially viable electric cars with the first consumer self-driving technology."

PRESIDENT DONALD TRUMP, QUOTED BY SAWYER MERRITT · @SAWYERMERRITT · [POST](#), THU 2:53 P.M. EDT

Software 2026.38.3.1

A new non-FSD update began reaching owners on Thursday, according to [Not a Tesla App's release notes](#). It adds Emergency Drive Away, which lets a driver shift into Drive with a

Supercharger cable still connected in an emergency (camera clips are shared with Tesla, and the owner may pay for damage); Halloween Mode with a "Ghost Costume" and a Trick or Treat Mode; Set Arrival Energy from the phone app; dynamic headlight leveling on some Model 3 and Cybertruck vehicles; and Supercharger site maps with live stall occupancy at pilot locations.

Next week: Paris and the Roadster

Tesla's stand at the Mondial de l'Auto in Paris, October 12–18 (Hall 7.1, stand C25), will show a Cybercab from the US robotaxi fleet, an Optimus Gen 2 humanoid robot, the Model 3 and Model Y, Tesla Energy products and a Supercharger, and will offer free FSD (Supervised) demonstration drives, the [show's organizers said](#). The next-generation Roadster unveiling remains set for Thursday, October 15, [TipRanks noted](#).

V · SEC FILINGS

Nothing new on EDGAR

No filings for Tesla, Inc. (CIK 0001318605) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system ([EDGAR](#)) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Thursday and 8:42 a.m. EDT Friday. Most recent filings on record:

Takeaways

1

FSD (Supervised) is now "Tesla Assisted Driving" on Tesla's European sites, a concession to Germany ahead of an EU vote expected no earlier than December.

2

Tesla's Texas registry count jumped to 319 Cybercabs and 739 robotaxis; NHTSA's Cybercab questions are due October 30.

3

Shanghai sold 95,366 cars in September and a record 275,111 in the quarter, with exports offsetting weaker sales in China.

4

The stock fell 0.74% to \$375.00, less than the Nasdaq 100's 1.39% drop; Tigress Financial kept a \$550 target.

5

Next: Paris show (Oct 12), Roadster (Oct 15), third-quarter results (Oct 21).

8-K · Oct 2, 9:04 a.m. EDT — Item 2.02 press release on third-quarter results: 464,391 vehicles produced, 486,532 delivered and 13.7 GWh of storage deployed. Third-quarter financial results come after the close on Wednesday, October 21, with a webcast at 5:30 p.m. EDT. [Filing](#)

8-K · Sep 29, 4:38 p.m. EDT — New unsecured credit agreements: a \$20.0 billion three-year delayed-draw term loan (Citibank as agent), an \$8.0 billion five-year revolving facility and a \$2.0 billion 364-day revolving facility (Wells Fargo as agent). [Filing](#)

Insider trades, last 120 days (Form 4) — Sep 8: Chief Financial Officer Vaibhav Taneja sold 2,605.75 shares at \$360.13 after 6,539 restricted stock units vested on Sep 5 ([filed Sep 9](#)). Jun 16: Elon Musk exercised options on 303,960,630 shares at \$23.34, with 17,531,857 shares withheld at \$404.66 ([filed Jun 17](#)).

SOURCES

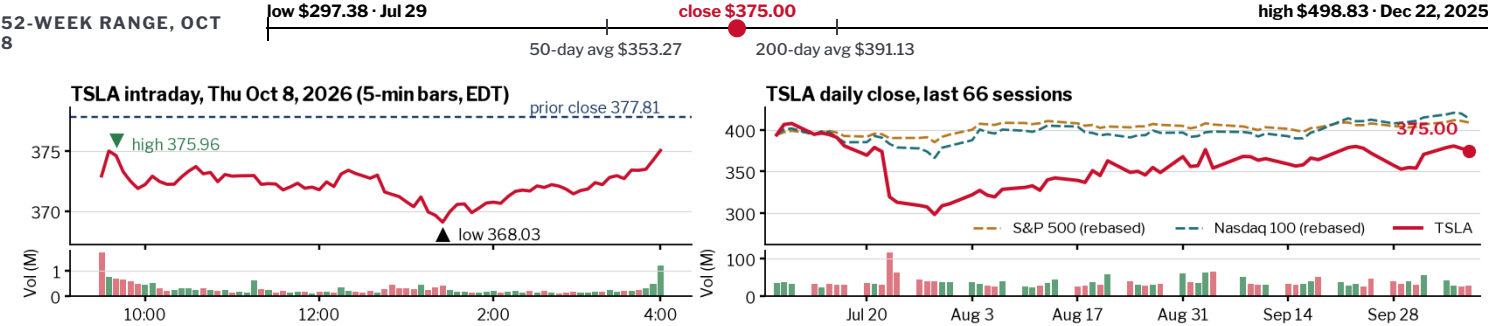
X posts from @SawyerMerritt, @tesla_semi, @TeslaCharging and the @TeslaSI profile; Not a Tesla App, Benzinga, EV (electric-vehicles.com), Reuters (via MarketScreener), Investing.com, Electrek, Cybercab.News, EVwire, Tesla Oracle, Lemonade via PR Newswire, CPCA via CnEVPost, Pilot newsroom, NBC News, the White House, Mondial de l'Auto, TipRanks, TheFly; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE.

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A second small dip, in a weaker market

TSLA eased 0.74% Thursday on volume a quarter below average, holding up better than the Nasdaq 100 as GM and Ford rose.

CLOSE \$375.00 Thu Oct 8, 4:00 p.m. EDT	CHANGE -\$2.81 -0.74% vs \$377.81	OPEN \$374.12 regular session	DAY HIGH \$375.96 9:40 a.m. EDT bar	DAY LOW \$368.03 1:25 p.m. EDT bar
VOLUME 28.31M -25.8% vs 30-session avg 38.17M	52-WEEK RANGE \$297-\$499 \$297.38 (Jul 29, 2026) to \$498.83 (Dec 22, 2025)	MARKET CAP \$1.48T 3.95B shares (10-Q cover, Jul 16) × close	5-DAY / 1-MONTH +5.90% / +1.95% 5 and 21 sessions	YEAR TO DATE -16.61% vs Dec 31, 2025 close



RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 8 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	YTD
TSLA	-0.74%	+5.90%	+1.95%	-16.61%
S&P 500	-0.47%	+1.29%	+1.69%	+13.44%
Nasdaq 100	-1.39%	+0.74%	+4.43%	+21.69%
RIVN	-0.07%	-2.91%	-10.47%	-27.30%
GM	+1.56%	+3.71%	-1.80%	+1.14%
F	+1.07%	-0.16%	-8.92%	-6.63%

OPTIONS SNAPSHOT (CBOE, FRI OCT 9, 8:34 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 9	219,753	254,209	1.16	35.7%	\$400 / \$150
Oct 12	31,704	28,034	0.88	27.7%	\$400 / \$370
Oct 14	11,630	9,823	0.84	32.9%	\$400 / \$360
All expiries	3,192,474	2,545,576	0.80	30-day IV index 43.1	

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 9

Strong buy	4
Buy	15
Hold	21
Sell	2
Strong sell	2
Mean rating (1 = strong buy)	2.36
Mean target (37 analysts)	\$392.42 (+4.6%)
Median target	\$410.00
High / low target	\$600.00 / \$128.11

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 15	68.86M
Change vs. mid-August	-0.5%
Short % of float	1.95%
Days to cover	1.79
Held by insiders	17.82%
Held by institutions	43.68%
BlackRock, Jun 30	5.42%
Vanguard, Jun 30	4.66%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 8 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS \$1.08)	347.2
Forward P/E (EPS est. \$2.14)	174.8
Price/sales (rev. \$103.6B)	14.3
Beta (5-year monthly)	1.92
50-day average	\$353.27 (+6.2%)
200-day average	\$391.13 (-4.1%)
Q3 EPS est. (26 analysts)	\$0.45
Q3 revenue est. (26)	\$28.02B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 8	Tigress Financial	Buy	\$550
Oct 7	Yorkville Ives	Outperform (initiated)	\$500
Oct 7	UBS	Neutral*	\$385 to \$391
Sep 28	JPMorgan	Neutral	\$445 to \$415
Sep 25	StoneX	Buy	\$475
Sep 16	Goldman Sachs	Neutral	\$360
Sep 4	GLJ Research	Sell	\$24.86

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Fri Oct 9	Weekly options expiry
Oct 12-18	Paris Motor Show (Tesla stand)
Thu Oct 15	Roadster unveiling
Fri Oct 16	Monthly options expiry
Wed Oct 21	Q3 results after close; webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT
Fri Oct 30	Cybercab answers due to NHTSA

Largest single option positions: Jan 15, 2027 \$960 calls (112,157 OI) and \$940 calls (93,671). Prices, volume, returns and moving averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 8). Consensus, targets, rating actions, short interest (as of Sep 15), ownership (holders as of Jun 30) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Fri Oct 9, 8:38 a.m. EDT; P/E (price to earnings per share, EPS) and price/sales recomputed at the Oct 8 close. *UBS: Yahoo Finance lists Neutral; TheFly listed Buy. Tigress: TheFly. Yorkville Ives: EV. Shares: Tesla 10-Q cover page, Jul 16, 2026. Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) is contracts outstanding after Thursday's close, P/C is the put/call ratio by OI, ATM IV is implied volatility at the \$375 strike. Earnings date: Tesla 8-K, Oct 2. NHTSA deadline: EVwire.